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'Apply full force of the law'

...HH warns violence, by any political party, supporter or candidate won't be tolerated

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Man kills self over deserted wife

By Ruth Kambita

A 42-year-old man of Chadiza District has taken his own life after his wife left the matrimonial home over his drinking habits.

It is alleged that Adriano Phiri now the deceased, had been having marital disputes with his wife, Grace Mbewe, for some time over alcohol abuse and on August 1, 2026, Ms Mbewe left the couple's home and went to stay with her parents in Chipata after growing increasingly unhappy with her husband's drinking.

Mr Phiri later left home around 10:00 hours yesterday and went on a drinking spree and returned home at about 01:00 hours in a drunken state and went straight to his house.

According to Eastern Province Police Commanding Officer Robertson Mweemba, at around 02:00 hours, his nephew checked on him and found him hanging from the roof with a black cotton belt around his neck.

Mr Mweemba said the nephew, shocked by what he saw, alerted other family members, who reported the matter to Chadiza Police Station.

He said Police officers who visited the scene found the body hanging from the roof of the house with his tongue protruding from the mouth.

Mr Mweemba said the body was later taken down and inspected in the presence of family members.

He said no foul play was suspected, and the body has since been deposited in Chadiza District Mortuary awaiting postmortem examination and burial.



President Hakainde Hichilema

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Real News in Real Time

By Linda Nyondo

El Niño preparedness underway

The United Nations in collaboration with the Zambian Government is set to counter effects of the anticipated El Niño.

The UN Agency working closely with the Disaster Management and Mitigation Unit (DMMU) is set to give an accurate position of how the collaborative emerging response will be implemented.

The two partners will also be able to determine the effect of the anticipated El Niño at the end of August 2026.

The partners who have drawn lessons from the past experiences and negative effects of El Niño which the country had experienced are this time preparing and will act proactively.

Their proactively is expected to mitigate the negative effect of the

anticipated disaster.

Zambia is expected to experience drought in some areas and floods in other areas in the forthcoming rainy season.

Meanwhile, the 2025 UN annual result report has demonstrated positive achievements in the implementation of programmes in collaboration with the Zambian Government.

Under the year under review, 70 000 small-holder farmers benefited under the livelihoods and productive capacities programmes with climate smart agriculture training.

While 30 000 households received drought tolerant seed packs as critical interventions that protected livelihoods and helped to safeguard future

harvest.

“Even amid economic difficulties, investments in people remained unwavering,” Outgoing UN Resident Coordinator Beatrice Mutali says.

The report has further indicated that Zambia sustained uninterrupted national vaccine availability throughout the year.

Through the ‘Big Catch Up; more than 461 000 children where reached with life saving immunization services.

It has further indicated advances in maternal and newborn health were made with neonatal prematurity and birth asphyxia, reflecting strengthened health systems and improved health delivery systems.

Additionally, the report

has indicated that regular cash assistance was delivered to 1.3 million households under the extended

Social Protection Scheme. An additional 60 000 vulnerable families where enrolled for health cover-

age under the National Health Insurance Authority (NHIMA).

Other notable achievements include equipping more than 14 000 youths with entrepreneurial skills and digital literacy.

12 nabbed for showgrounds theft

By Alex Maboshe

Twelve individuals have been arrested in connection with various offences committed during the 98th Zambia Agricultural and Commercial Show in Lusaka.

Police Public Relations Officer Godfrey Chilabi said one suspect was allegedly found tampering with a parked vehicle and that officers recovered a break-in instrument believed to have been used in the incident.

Police also recorded a case of theft by servant involving 13 tins of black shoe polish valued at K990.

Mr Chilabi revealed that the overall crime rate at this year’s show dropped sharply stating that only 32 criminal cases and one road traffic accident were

registered during the six-day event, held from 29 July to 3 August 2026 at the Showgrounds under the theme “Fostering Trade and Investment.”

This represents a reduction of more than half compared with the previous year, when 65 criminal cases were reported a 50.8 per cent decrease.

The estimated value of stolen property also fell, from K339,590 in 2025 to K183,950 in 2026.

Sunday August. 2 was the busiest day for police, with 16 cases reported. No incidents were recorded on Wednesday. Thursday saw two cases, Friday three, Saturday four and Monday seven.

Theft from the person was by far the most common offence, ac-

counting for 21 of the 32 cases.

Mobile phones made up the majority of these thefts as over nineteen mobile phones were reported stolen during the show, ten of them on Sunday alone.

A further six theft cases involved laptops, groceries and other personal property.

Three cases of assault occasioning actual bodily harm were also recorded.

Other missing items included six handbags, three laptops, groceries, cash and personal documents.

Police say the suspects remain in custody as investigations continue, with efforts ongoing to recover additional stolen property and arrest further suspects.

‘General Kanene not dead’

By Alex Maboshe

Musician Clifford Dimba, popularly known as General Kanene, is alive and receiving treatment at the University Teaching Hospital (UTH) in Lusaka, contrary to social media reports claiming he had died.

Police spokesperson Godfrey Chilabi confirmed that Dimba sustained injuries on Monday when armed thugs disrupted a campaign rally in Nampeya Ward, Munyati Area of Shibunji District where the artist was performing.

The gathering was being addressed by independent parliamentary aspirant Ibrahim Kabwe Mwamba and independent counsel chairperson candidate Mutumba Denise.

According to Chilabi, preliminary investigations show that a Toyota Land Cruiser carrying criminals armed with machetes arrived at the scene and violently broke up the meeting.

The attackers allegedly assaulted Dimba, cutting him on the head, and damaged a Mitsubishi Triton belonging to

Mwamba.

The thugs also allegedly stole an HP ProBook laptop, two mobile phones and K16,000 in cash. The value of other damaged property is still being assessed.

Police officers responded promptly to the scene, recovering one machete that has been retained as an exhibit.

Dimba was taken to Westwood Police Station, where he was issued a medical report before being referred to UTH and admitted for treatment.

Dockets have been opened for aggravated robbery, unlawful wounding and malicious damage to property.

Chilabi said investigations are ongoing and that the matter is being treated as a serious criminal offence.

“All those involved will be identified, arrested and prosecuted in accordance with Zambian law.” Further updates will be provided as investigations progress,” he said.

The Zambia Police Service has condemned the violence and reminded the public and all political stakeholders that violence has no place in a democratic society.

‘Apply full force of the law’

By Alex Maboshe

Political violence has erupted in Western Province with reported serious injuries after two major political rivals clashed.

President Hakainde Hichilema has since strongly condemned the reported violence not only in Mongu but in other parts of the country, saying such conduct will not be tolerated.

He warned that violence, intimidation or lawlessness by any political party, candidate or supporter would be met with the full force of the law.

“Let it be clear that violence, intimidation, or lawlessness by any political party, candidate, or supporter will not be tolerated,” Mr Hichilema said.

The President reiterated that every political party has a lawful right to campaign within the period allocated by the Electoral Commission of Zambia.

He said anyone who attempts to disrupt or prevent that process is breaking the law and must face the full

consequences.

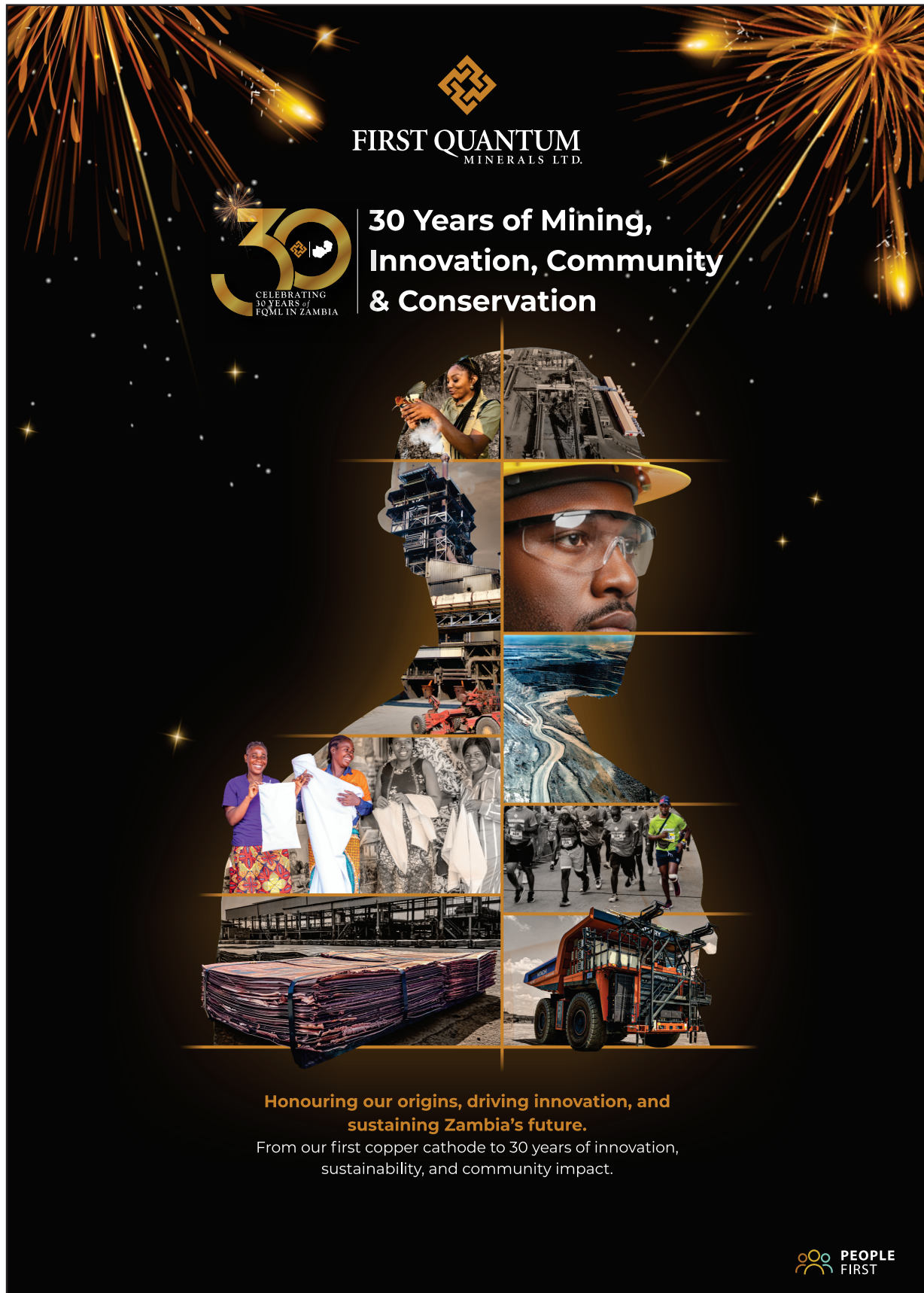
It is alleged that a group of the ruling party confronted the opposition camp for Brian Mundubile and his running mate Makebi Zulu.

Armature video clips circulating on social media show individuals believed to be from the ruling party in an offensive mode.

Efforts by police to try and stop the group resulted in a fracas that saw police fire several warning shots as the groups disregard missiles in form of stones towards the opposing group and police.

Meanwhile Mr Zulu has confirmed the incident on his Facebook page, calling on President Hichilema to call off all political thugs who were denting the Zambian political stage.

The Mongu incident follows a separate one reported yesterday in Nampeya Ward, Munyati area of Shibuyunji District, where independent parliamentary aspirant Ibrahim Kabwe Mwamba and independent counsel chairperson candidate Mutumba Denise were addressing a rally.



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PEOPLE FIRST

Chipata baby thief cornered

By Ruth Kambita

A 26-year-old woman of Chipata District who vanished with her neighbour's

five-month-old baby has been arrested, barely four days after the child was taken. Sylvia Mwewa now the

suspect was apprehended yesterday at around 15:00 hours in Chongwe, Lusaka, and is detained at Chongwe Police Station.

Confirming the incident, Eastern Province Police Commanding Officer Robertson Mweemba said the baby boy has since been reunited with his mother.

He said arrangements were being made to transfer the suspect to Chipata Central Police Station to answer charges related to the incident.

It is alleged that Ms Mwewa, who was initially reported as Sera Daka, aged 24, asked the 16-year-old mother to allow her to bathe the baby and cook for him before leaving with the child on July 30.

She was later seen heading to town, but when calls were made to her phone, she did not answer and the device later went off, prompting a report to the police.



Vice President Mutale Nalumango tours Chinyunyu Market in Rufunsa District. Pictures by Royd Sibajene ZANIS.

‘Ngoni can now dance’

By Ruth Kambita

The Ngoni Royal Establishment has lifted several cultural restrictions that were imposed in Ngoni land following the death of Paramount Chief Mpezeni IV.

Senior Chief Nzamane, speaking through Nc’wala Organizing Committee chairperson Joshua Jere, said the move allows the Ngoni people to resume traditional dances and other cultural practices that had been suspended out of respect for the late Paramount Chief.

Activities specifically pre- scribed over by the Paramount Chief, however, will remain suspended.

“Customarily there were no

performances of any kind in homes and elsewhere. They observed this and decided that the mourning period should be lifted, meaning we return to our normal ways.

If it is dancing, we need to do that. If there are activities such as weddings, they may proceed,” Senior Chief Nzamane said.

The decision permits activities that were put on hold during the initial mourning period to restart, he added.

Paramount Chief Mpezeni IV died in Lusaka on May 30, 2026, bringing to an end a 44-year reign. Ngoni tradition requires a year-long mourning period, during which certain ceremonies and cultural events are usually restricted.

1 more arrested in East violence

By Ruth Kambita

One more person has been arrested in an attack on United Party for National Development (UPND) youths in Chibale, Chama District, that left property worth about K200,000 damaged and K30,000 stolen.

The latest arrest is 47-year-old Chilufya Sinyenga. He joins Donald Kumwenda, 45, and John Gondwe, 38, all from Chibale, who were detained earlier.

The incident occurred on Sunday morning as UPND members were preparing for a 14:00 hours gathering at a lodge belonging to Kelvin Mukisi, a UPND Youth Chairperson for Chibale area in Chama District.

At about 09:00, party members reported that NRPUP supporters had stripped his son Kelvin Mukisi Jr. of UPND regalia and set it on fire. Shortly afterwards another member, Johnimba, was reportedly stripped of party regalia and had his bicycle seized.

As UPND youths returned from Nkula Village they were allegedly ambushed by a group of National Reconciliation Party for Unity and Prosperity (NRPUP) supporters who pelted them with stones. The youths took refuge in the lodge but were pursued.

According to Eastern Province Police Commanding Officer Robertson Mweemba, the attackers caused malicious damage to the lodge and five adjoining flats losses are estimated at K150,000 and damaged solar panels valued at about K50,000.

Mr Mweemba said during the chaos two bales of UPND regalia (T-shirts and wrappers) and a bag containing K30,000 from Mr Mukisi’s office were stolen. Mr Mukisi escaped and reported the matter to Isoka Police Station.

“The incident borders on political violence, malicious damage to property and theft,” the police officer said.

All three suspects have been taken to Chama Police Station. Police added that 24 other suspects remain at large and no recoveries have been made to date.

Don’t campaign on number plates - TI-Z

By Ruth Kambita

Transparency International Zambia (TI-Z) has raised concern over the increasing use of campaign vehicles with concealed number plates, saying the practice undermines transparency and accountability as Zambia moves closer to the 2026 general elections.

Speaking during the Sixth Election Monitoring Update under the Kuteteza Masankho Project, TI-Z Executive Director Maurice Nyambe said election monitors deployed in all 10 provinces had observed an increase in vehicles used during campaign activities with registration plates covered or obscured.

Mr Nyambe said the concealment makes it difficult for the public and law enforcement agencies to identify vehicles involved in traffic offences, electoral breaches or political violence.

He also said the practice fuels suspicion over whether some vehicles may belong to the Government of the Republic of Zambia rather than private owners, heightening concerns about the use of public resources in campaigns.

Mr Nyambe urged the Road Transport and Safety Agency

and Zambia Police to enforce the law without political bias.

On the ballot paper printing exercise in Dubai, Mr Nyambe praised the Electoral Commission of Zambia for accrediting political party representatives, civil society groups, observers and the media, and for issuing regular

updates on operational matters.

He said the process helped strengthen public confidence, though some stakeholders had raised concerns over delays and the cost of observing the exercise.

Mr Nyambe also warned public officers against engag-

ing in partisan politics.

He said civil servants must remain neutral and professional during the election period.

Mr Nyambe said the credibility of the poll depends on the conduct of stakeholders throughout the campaign, not only on polling day.

5 jailed five yrs for Pangolin possession

By Luyando Mukuka

The Lusaka Magistrates’ Court has sentenced five people to five years’ imprisonment with hard labour each for the illegal possession of a live ground pangolin, following their conviction for contravening the Zambia Wildlife Act.

Those convicted are Lutangu Namushi, 35, Melody Mwangala, 39, Peter Mukela, 32, Abigail Sitali, 22, and Nawa Pelekelo, 33.

According to a statement issued by Wildlife Crime Prevention (WCP) Assistant Communications Officer Salima Mvula on behalf of the Department of National Parks and Wildlife (DNPW), the convictions stem from an intelligence-led operation that uncovered the illegal transportation of a live pangolin from Kalabo District to Lusaka.

Ms Mvula said the five were apprehended after DNPW officers intercepted them at Novare Mall in Lusaka on February 1, 2026, in possession of a live ground pangolin weighing about seven kilograms.

She said investigations established that the protected animal had been sourced from Kalabo District and transported to Lusaka, where it was allegedly intended for sale to foreign buyers.

Ms Mvula explained that all five accused initially pleaded not guilty to the charge. However, Peter Mukela changed his plea to guilty on May 15, 2026, and was immediately convicted and sentenced to five years’ imprisonment with hard labour.

“The remaining four accused

persons proceeded to trial before the Lusaka Magistrates’ Court,” Ms Mvula said.

She said on July 28, 2026, Magistrate Mutinta Mwenya found Lutangu Namushi, Melody Mwangala, Abigail Sitali and Nawa Pelekelo guilty of the offence and sentenced each of them to five years’ imprisonment with hard labour.

Ms Mvula said the successful prosecution underscores the importance of intelligence-led operations in disrupting wildlife trafficking networks and demonstrates Zambia’s commitment to combating wildlife crime.

She noted that pangolins are protected under the Zam-

bia Wildlife Act and remain among the world’s most heavily trafficked mammals because of the illegal demand for their scales and meat.

“The illegal trade in pangolins remains a serious threat to Zambia’s biodiversity, and offenders will be held accountable under the law,” Ms Mvula said.

She further urged members of the public to help protect wildlife by refraining from buying, selling or keeping pangolins and encouraged anyone with information on wildlife crime to report it to the nearest police station or Department of National Parks and Wildlife office.

‘End election violence’

By Luyando Mukuka

Mufulira based Catholic priest Fr. Augustine Mwewa has challenged state institutions to take decisive action against election-related violence being reported in parts of the country ahead of the August 13 general elections.

Fr. Mwewa said the Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ) and the Zambia Police Service should take practical steps to curb violence and ensure that those responsible are held accountable.

He cited incidents reported in Solwezi, Kitwe, Magoye, Ndola and Lusaka, among other areas, saying continued political violence threatens the holding of peaceful elections.

Fr. Mwewa expressed concern that some incidents have resulted in loss of life, particularly in Magoye, Kaputa

and Lusaka.

He said ECZ and the police should move beyond statements and ensure that the Electoral Code of Conduct and relevant laws are enforced without favour.

The cleric also challenged President Hakainde Hichilema to publicly denounce all forms of political violence, including incidents being attributed to members of the governing United Party for National Development (UPND).

Fr. Mwewa said political differences should not be allowed to undermine peace and called on political parties and their supporters to exercise restraint during the election period.

He urged Zambians to safeguard the country’s peace and work towards ensuring that the August 13 elections are conducted in a peaceful environment.

UNZA off-campus students get top-up accommodation allowance

By Ruth Kambita

The Higher Education Loans and Scholarships Board (HELSEB) has today started paying a K1,950 accommodation allowance to eligible University of Zambia (UNZA) students living off campus.

This is barely three days after President Hakainde Hichilema’s directive that the allowance be increased from K3,900 to K5,850 for off-campus students. The K1,950 represents the differ-

ence between the original and revised rates.

HELSEB Chief Executive Officer John Machayi said the board began administrative and financial steps immediately after the Presidential announcement and started processing payments as soon as the funds were credited to its account.

“Eligible beneficiaries should expect the accommodation allowance top-up to begin reflecting in their respective bank accounts in accordance with normal banking and electronic

funds transfer processing timelines,” Dr Machayi said.

He expressed gratitude to the government for supporting student welfare and thanked students for their patience while HELSEB completed the necessary procedures.

The top-up is limited to HELSEB-sponsored UNZA students who reside off campus. The board did not say how many students will benefit or when all payments will be finalized.

Rangers sign striker Tranquilin Mwepu from Kansanshi

By Benedict Tembo

Nchanga Rangers have signed Congolese striker Tranquilin Kalonji Mwepu on a one-year, six-month contract.

The talented forward joins the Bravo Family as a free agent, becoming the latest addition to coach George Lwandamina's squad as the club continues to strengthen its ranks ahead of the forthcoming MTN Super League season.

Mwepu arrives at Rangers following an impressive two-year spell with Kansanshi Dynamos Football Club, where he finished as the club's leading goal scorer in both campaigns.

His consistent goal scoring record, movement in the final third and attacking presence make him a valuable addition to the Rangers frontline.

Andrew Ukwimi, Rangers'

Media and Public Relations Officer said the club believes Mwepu's experience and proven ability in front of goal will significantly enhance the team's attacking options as preparations intensify for the new campaign.

Speaking on the signing, club president David Mukelabai expressed confidence that the striker possesses the quality, determination and professionalism required to contribute to the team's ambitions this season.

"We are delighted to welcome Tranquilin Kalonji Mwepu to the Rangers Family. We believe he will add quality and strength to our squad, and we wish him every success as he embarks on this new chapter in Bravo colors" Mukelabai said.

He said the club's executive committee is pleased with the off-season transfers and looks forward to a successful 2026 Transitional League.

Hauptle confident Copper Queens can finish the job against Malawi



Copper Queens coach Nora Hauptle says Zambia's quarter-final hopes remain in their own hands ahead of tomorrow's decisive Group C match against Malawi at the ongoing TotalEnergies CAF WAFCON in Rabat, Morocco.

Zambia face the Scorchers at Al Madina Stadium in Rabat at 22:00 CAT and must win to stay in contention for a place in the last eight; while Malawi will only need a draw to finish top of the group.

Hauptle says her side is approaching the match with positivity and without relying on qualification permutations.

"We are in a good position, all in our hands. For me, it's a privilege to be in this situation. To play the last game in this group and to be in the situation where it's in our hands. We don't need to rely on other results but what we face; that's not pressure," Hauptle said.

The Swiss trainer said Zambia will stick to its game plan instead of worrying about qualification scenarios.

"We are in a very good situation. It's all in our hands. Of course, we have seen all these calculations, but we don't go out and calculate tomorrow on the pitch. We go out and focus on our performance, as always. We have a clear approach to how we want to face Malawi. I think we played three very good halftimes out of the last four, and we want to build on this stable approach."

Hauptle expects another tough meeting with Malawi, saying the two sides are evenly matched and know each other well.

"This squad is as equal to us. They have top players on the club level, and they have players abroad; they also have good players in the squad behind the top players. So it's a very similar team in the picture to our team. We know about their strength. We also played against each other a lot, so players know each other. Tactic-wise, there are not so many secrets, I would say, in this game, but again, we bounce back to us." She said.

And Hauptle provided an update on Racheal Kundananji, who limped off during the narrow defeat to the Super Falcons.

She said Kundananji was being treated for muscle strain that she suffered during the game.

And goalkeeper Hazel Nali says the Copper Queens are fully aware of what is at stake and are ready for the challenge.

"We know exactly what we want and we know exactly what's on the table. Our main focus is to work extra hard because football is played on the pitch. What we want as a team is to fight and give our all for the country," Nali said.

Nali said Zambia will not be distracted by previous results against Malawi.

"When you're playing football, you don't play based on history. We're not moved or shaken by the past matches we've played against Malawi. What is going to count is how we display ourselves tomorrow."

She has also called for unity, saying the Copper Queens must work together to deal with Malawi's pace and keep their WAFCON campaign alive.

"We want to play as a team because we're in this together and we want to do this together. The team we're going to play has players with speed, just like we have in training with Barbra Banda, Rachael Kundananji and the others. That is something we're working on as a team. It may be considered one of our weaknesses, but trust me, we're working on it and hopefully we'll get it right in tomorrow's game."

FAZ

Nkwazi head to CB for 10 day pre-season training

By Benedict Tembo

Nkwazi Football Club have commenced their next phase of preparations for the 2026 Transitional League after setting up a 10 day pre-season training camp on the Copperbelt

Province.

The High Flying Nkwazi shifted camp to the Copperbelt on Saturday, where the technical bench and players will engage in an intensive programme aimed at building fitness, improving tactical awareness, team bonding and

cohesion ahead of the new campaign.

As part of the camp, Nkwazi will also play a series of friendly matches, providing the technical bench with an opportunity to assess the squad in competitive conditions while giving players

valuable match fitness.

Speaking before the team's departure, coach Masauso Tembo expressed confidence that the camp will play a vital role in laying the foundation for a successful campaign.

"This camp is an important part of our preparations

for the Transitional League. It gives us the opportunity to work closely with the players in a focused environment, improve our fitness levels, and continue building the identity and mentality we want as a team.

"The friendly matches will also be important in helping us evaluate our progress and ensure the players are ready for the demands of the new season," Tembo told Nkwazi FC media.

The club remains committed to ensuring the squad is fully prepared to compete at the highest level when the 2026 Transitional League gets underway, with the Copperbelt camp marking another significant milestone in Nkwazi's pre-season programme.

Zesco Girls to face Gaborone in Champs League COSAFA qualifiers

By Benedict Tembo

Zesco Ndola Girls have been drawn in Group 'A' of the African Women's Champions League COSAFA Qualifier 2026 and will contend with defending champions Gaborone United of Botswana.

According to the draw conducted yesterday in

Gaborone, Zesco Girls were the seeded team in Pot 1 and will also face Lesotho Defence Force Ladies, and Herentals Queens FC from Zimbabwe in the tough Group 'A'.

Gaborone go into the tournament as hot favourites having won the regional qualifiers last year.

Zesco Girls who lost to Gaborone in the 2025 final on their tournament debut, will be looking to go

one better.

Zimbabwe's Herentals Queens reached the last four in 2024, also losing to Gaborone United, which remains their best finish to date.

Lesotho Defence Force on their part will make their third appearance in the competition and their first since 2023, with the aim of progressing beyond the group stage for the first time.